

Soldering Irons

A soldering iron is arguably the most important tool that aids in the process of soldering. The most basic operations require a soldering iron and some solder to complete the task at hand. Let's delve into the parts of a soldering iron.



Soldering Tips - The iron tip is the part of the iron that heats up and lets the solder flow around the pieces that are being

joined. A common misconception is that the iron tip transfers solder when it actually transfers heat which then raises the temperature of the metal components to the melting point of the solder, hence joining them together. Most irons allow you to change the tip so you can replace an old one or even switch the style of the tip. Tips come in a wide variety of sizes and shapes to accommodate any component you choose.

Wand - The wand holds the tip on a soldering iron and is the part that is handled by the user. Wands are usually made up of insulating materials to prevent them from getting hot to the touch. They also house wires and metal contacts that transfer heat from the base to the tip. Therefore, it has somewhat of a dual role of heating and preventing burns.



Base - The base of a soldering iron is basically the control box that allows users to adjust temperatures. The wand is attached to the base and receives heat from the electronics sitting inside. There are analogue bases which use dials to control the temperature as well as digital ones that have buttons to set the temperature, along with a display that relays this temperature.